[1] Making shoes is a craft handed down from father to son in Syria. Diyaa and his family had been making shoes for decades before the war obliged them to leave their home in Damascus. Now, **they** are settled in Morocco and Diyaa is a successful business model.

[2] When he arrived in Morocco, Diyaa settled with his family on the outskirts of Casablanca, but he started his shoe-making workshop in a small street of the city. He started from nothing, working long hours to make sandals and shoes. "At the beginning, I worked for 18 to 20 hours a day and lived 20 km away from Casablanca. Each day, I had a two-hour ride to get to work," he says.

[3] Gradually, Diyaa's hard work gave good results. His determination to succeed allowed him to have more customers and orders. With the help of a grant from the refugee organization UNHCR, he bought his first sewing machine and other shoe-making tools. "In the beginning, I worked alone. Then I received the first sewing machine as part of a UNHCR support for refugees. It was a real motivation for me. Today, I employ four Moroccan workers. Moroccans have always inspired confidence in me. As an employer, I feel reassured working hand in hand with them," he says.

[4] In recognition of his efforts and contribution to his host country, Diyaa was awarded a prize by the Moroccan association MASPSE. "The prize was a surprise for me. I never thought my hard work and perseverance would be recognized in a foreign country. I came here with empty pockets," he said. "Thanks to my work, my family and I are able to progress. Whenever I had difficulties, my wife would tell me to never give up, to go forward and to get up every time I fell down," he continued.

[5] Diyaa not only employs young Moroccans from a poor neighborhood, but he also helped other Syrians to open their own shoe-making workshop nearby. He has also opened a second shop in Casablanca. He's really a model by his entrepreneurial spirit. Previously, Diyaa had no car. With a small income, he could afford little. Today, he finds Morocco comfortable. He can provide for his family and is renting an apartment closer to his work.

[6] In recent years, thousands of refugees have not only found safety in Morocco, but also a space where they can manifest their creativity and entrepreneurial skills. "People **here** do not consider us as refugees but as citizens," says Diyaa. "In Morocco, I have never felt like a foreigner."

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS) BASE ALL YOUR ANSWERS ON THE TEXT.

A. ARE THESE STATEMENTS TRUE OR FALSE? JUSTIFY. (3 pts)

1. Making shoes is a modern industry in Syria.

. . . . . .

2. Diyaa started his shoe-making workshop in a big street in Casablanca.

. . . . . .

3. When Diyaa arrived in Morocco, he had no money with him.

B. CHOOSE THE RIGHT ANSWER. (a, b or c) (2 pts)

1. Diyaa and his family settled in Morocco because . . . . . .
   a. they wanted to have a business in Morocco.

b. Diyaa wanted his children to study in Morocco.

c. they were obliged to leave their country.

The answer: . . . . . .

2. The grant which Diyaa received from UNHCR helped him to . . . . . .

a. start his own shoe-making workshop.

b. buy necessary equipment for his workshop.

c. open a second workshop in Casablanca.

The answer: . . . . . .

C. ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS. (2 pts)

1. How long did it take Diyaa to get to work when he first started his workshop?

. . . . . .

2. How did Diyaa help other Syrians in Morocco?

. . . . . .

D. COMPLETE THE SENTENCES WITH INFORMATION FROM THE TEXT. (2 pts)

1. .Diyaa was given a prize by a Moroccan association thanks to . . . . . .

. . . . . .

2. At the beginning of his work in Morocco, Diyaa couldn't have a car because . . . . . .

. . . . . .

E. PICK OUT FROM THE TEXT SENTENCES OR PHRASES WHICH SHOW THAT (2 pts)

1. Diyaa trusts his Moroccan workers (paragraph 3): . . . . . .

. . . . . .

2. Diyaa is satisfied with his life in Morocco (paragraph 5): . . . . . .

. . . . . .

F. F. FIND IN THE TEXT WORDS THAT MEAN ALMOST THE SAME AS (2 pts)

1. clients (paragraph 3): . . . . . .

2. show (paragraph 6): . . . . . .

G. WHAT DO THE UNDERLINED WORDS IN THE TEXT REFER TO?

1. they (paragraph 1): . . . . . .

2. here (paragraph 6): . . . . . .

KEY AND MARKING SCALE

Baccalaureate English National Exam Humanities July 2024 · Accept any appropriate answer not mentioned in this key.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

A. Are these statements true or false? Justify. (3 pts)

1. **False.** "Making shoes is a craft handed down from father to son in Syria." (paragraph 1)
2. **False.** He started his workshop "in a small street of the city." (paragraph 2)
3. **True.** "I came here with empty pockets." (paragraph 4)

B. Choose the right answer. (2 pts)

1. c. they were obliged to leave their country.
2. b. buy necessary equipment for his workshop.

C. Answer the following questions. (2 pts)

1. Two hours (a two-hour ride each day).
2. He helped them open their own shoe-making workshop nearby.

D. Complete the sentences with information from the text. (2 pts)

1. …his efforts and his contribution to his host country (his hard work and perseverance).
2. …he had a small income and could afford little.

E. Pick out from the text sentences or phrases which show that: (2 pts)

1. "Moroccans have always inspired confidence in me."
2. "Today, he finds Morocco comfortable."

F. Find in the text words that mean almost the same as: (2 pts)

1. customers
2. manifest

G. What do the underlined words in the text refer to? (2 pts)

1. Diyaa and his family
2. Morocco